Implementing Maritime Single Windows: Opportunities and Challenges in Asia and the Pacific



Key Amendments and Trends of IMO FAL Conventions

12 June 2025

ESCAP, Bangkok

Facilitation

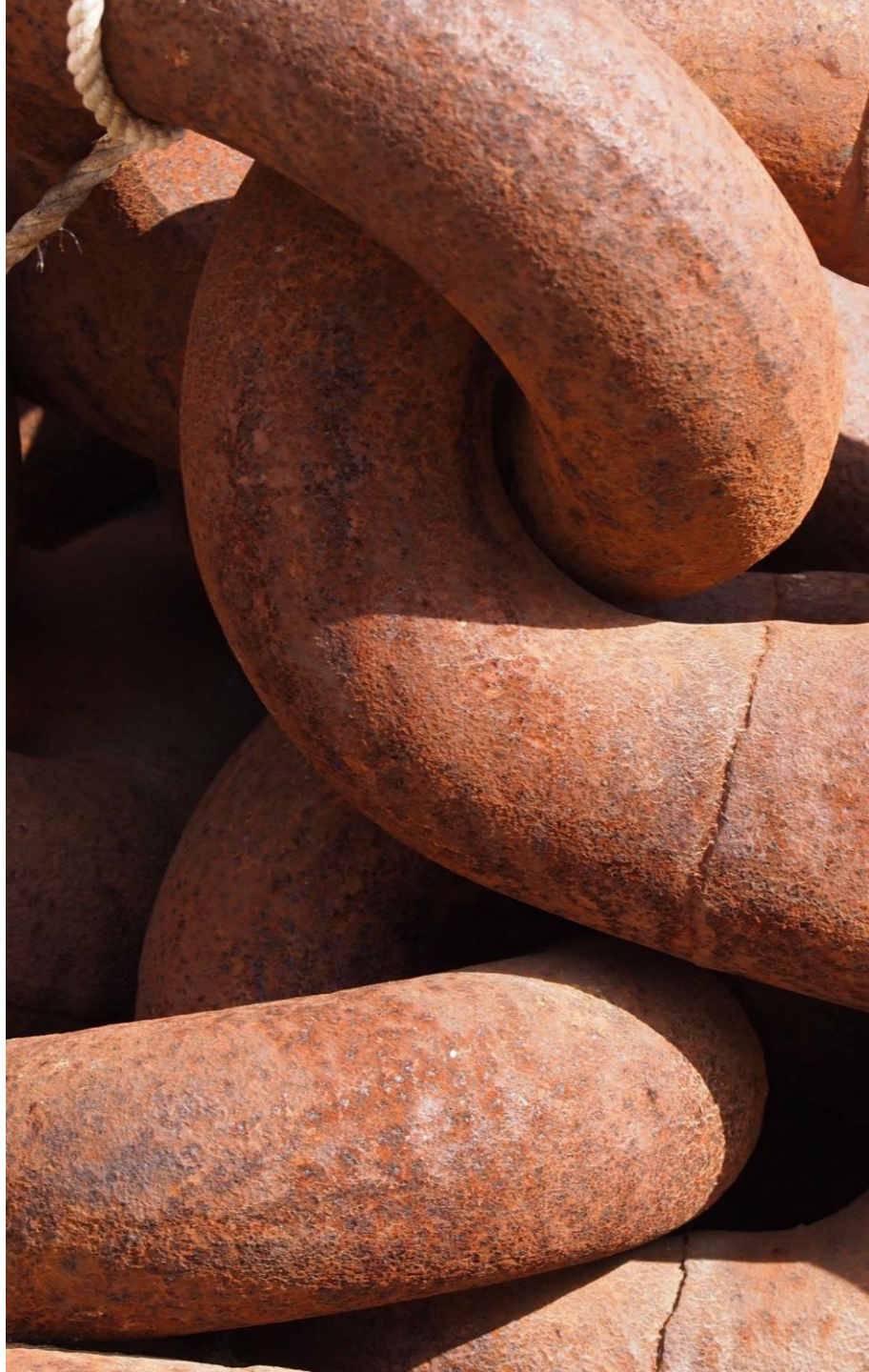
- FAL = Facilitation of International Maritime Traffic

Situation

- Documents required varied from port to port; number of copies required could often become excessive
- Other burden: local language translations, visa requirements, variation of document forms

Convention on Facilitation of International Maritime Traffic

- FAL Convention was adopted in April 1965 and entered into force in March 1967
- To facilitate maritime transport by simplifying and minimizing the formalities, documentary requirements and procedures associated with the arrival, stay and departure of ships engaged on international voyages.



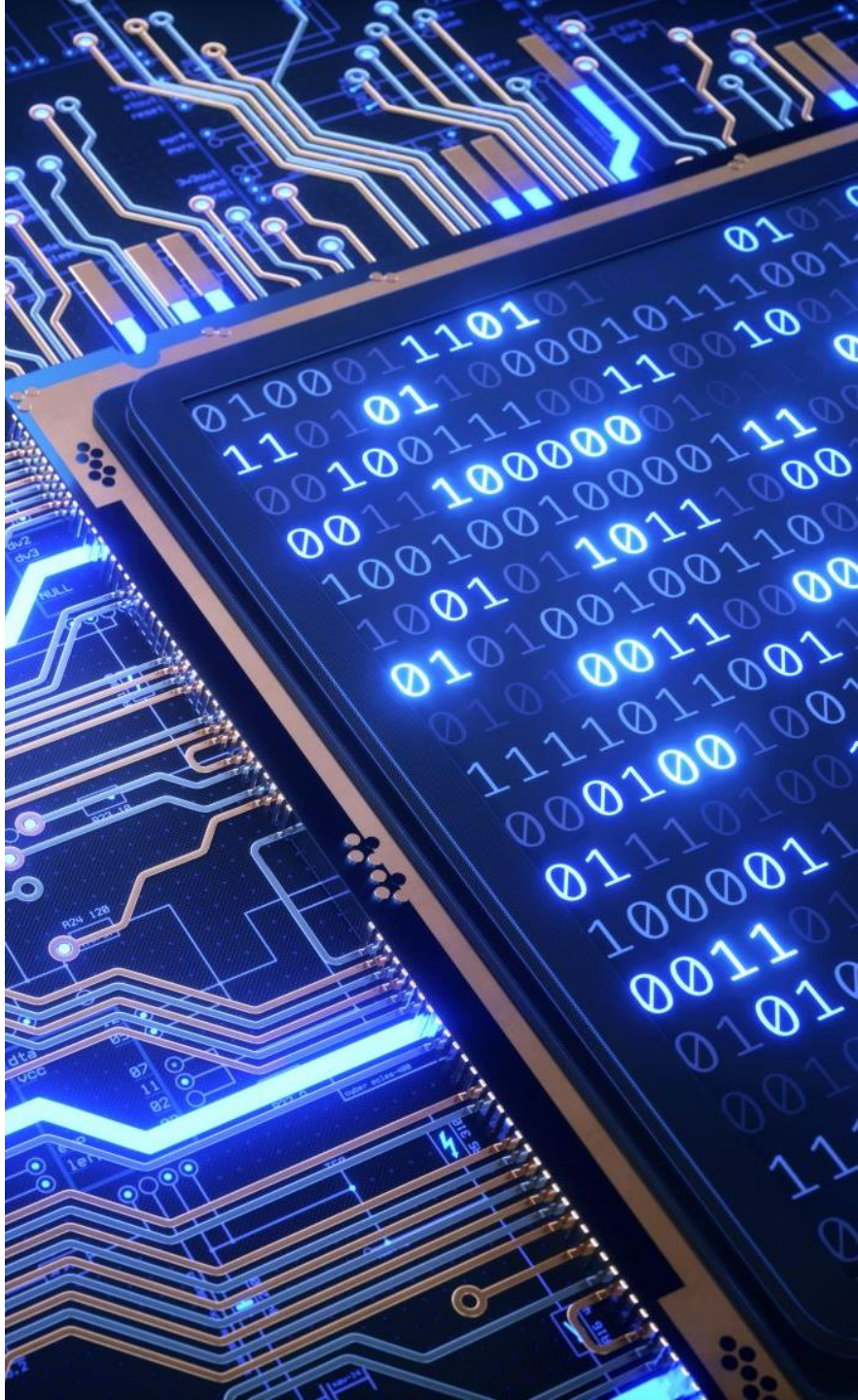
IMO Facilitation Committee

- Last session: FAL 49 in March 2025
- Attended by Maritime, Port, Customs, Health, Police, Immigration authorities, IGOs and NGOs, etc.
- Call for more involvement of relevant authorities and stakeholders.



Recent Developments of MSW

- **Mandatory of Maritime Single Window**: since 1 January 2024
  - **Obligation**: Public Authorities have to combine the electronic transmission of data to ensure that the info is submitted or provided only once and re-used.
  - **Recommended actions adopted by FAL 47**: urges Governments to adopt, implement and effectively apply the MSW concept to ship and port clearance processes; and share know-how and experiences with States seeking assistance in developing their MSW
- **Guidelines for setting up a maritime single window**
  - Revised version FAL.5/Circ.42/Rev.4 (FAL 49)



Complementary to MSW

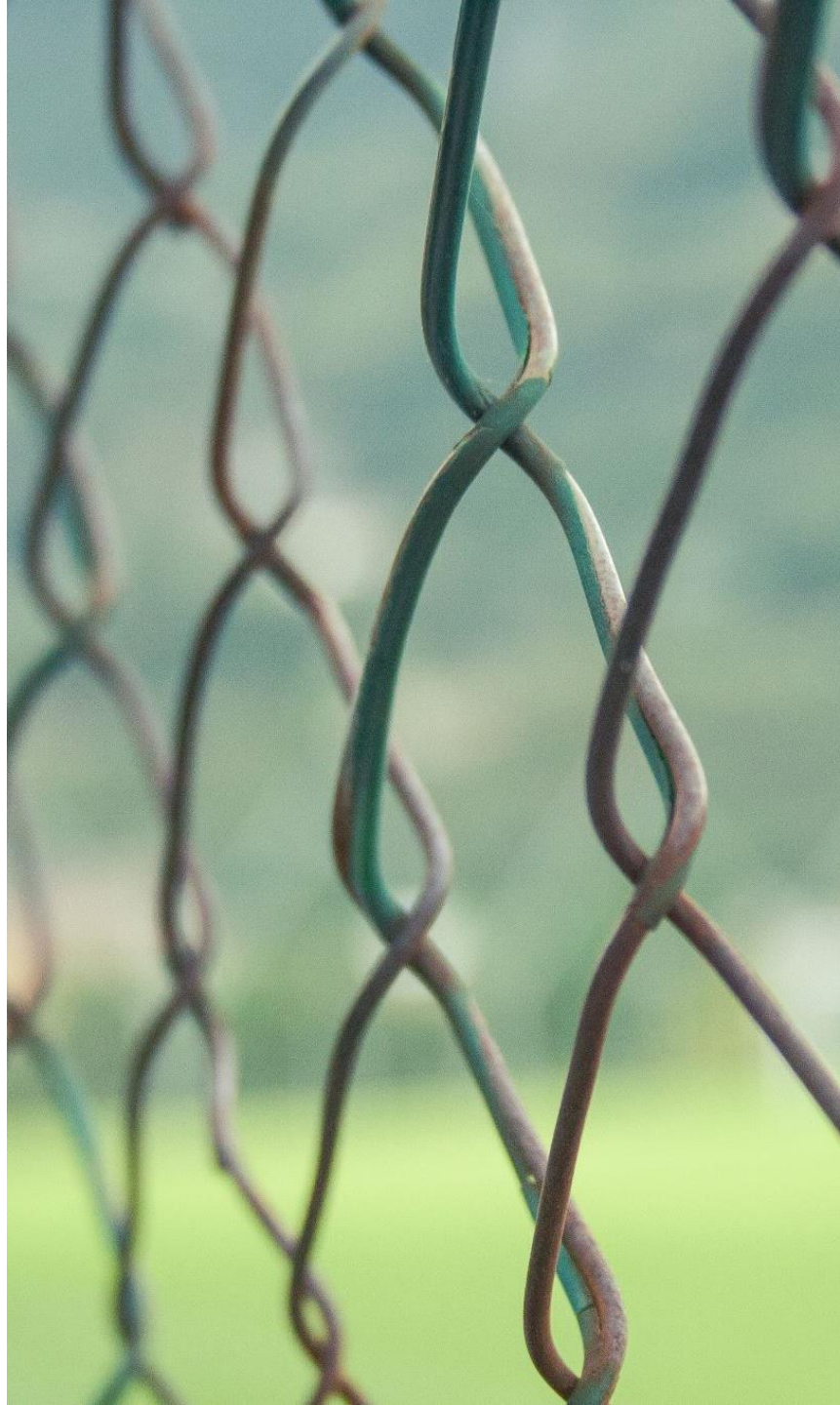
- **New Guidelines on Port Community Systems**
  - PCS serve as a complementary instrument to MSW in port and terminal operations.
  - The Guidelines provide understanding of PCS and baseline considerations for PCS development

- **New version of the IMO Compendium on facilitation and electronic business**
  - IMO Compendium: an IMO data set and IMO Reference Data Model agreed by IMO and standards bodies ISO UNECE and WCO
  - The IMO Reference Model serves as a guide for developing the ICT systems
  - Contracting States are recommended to use IMO Compendium when setting up and improve MSW to ensure that IT systems from different stake holders can exchange data electronically



Some related works

- **Development of a comprehensive strategy on maritime digitalization**
  - Work plan agreed
  - To be adopted by the IMO Assembly in 2027
  - Utilise emerging technologies to enhance efficiency, safety and sustainability in the shipping industry.
  - It’s a cross-cutting strategy to foster a fully interconnected, harmonized and automated global maritime sector.
- **Cybersecurity for Maritime Single Window**
- **Measures to address Maritime Autonomous Surface Ships (MASS)**



Coming soon

FAL 50

- Amendments to the FAL Convention to introduce mandatory cybersecurity measures to safeguard the maritime single windows
- Revision of the *Guidelines on Maritime Cyber Risk Management* (MSC-FAL.1/Circ.3/Rev.2) and identification of next steps to enhance maritime cybersecurity
- Development of a comprehensive strategy on maritime digitalization
- Measures to address Maritime Autonomous Surface Ships (MASS)
  - Non-mandatory MASS Code
  - Mandatory MASS Code



Thank you